

Family Planning

Family planning means you decide when to have children, how many, and how far apart. It is your choice, and the methods are free at government health facilities.

For community members

Key messages

- A woman can become pregnant when she has sex with a man on her fertile days. A pregnancy lasts about 40 weeks.
- Spacing pregnancies protects the health of mothers and babies.
- There are many methods: condoms, an implant (replaced every 3 to 5 years), an injection every 3 months, an IUD (3 to 10 years), pills, and permanent methods for women or men.
- Condoms are the only method that also protects against sexually transmitted infections, including HIV.

- If a condom breaks or you had sex without protection, the emergency pill works up to 5 days afterwards.
- Side effects are different for every woman. Talk to a health worker to choose what suits you.
- All family planning methods are free at government and government-supported health facilities. If you are asked to pay, tell your ward health committee or the health centre manager.

See a health worker if

- You have a side effect or problem that worries you
- You had sex without protection and do not want to be pregnant
- You think you may have a sexually transmitted infection

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.